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Priya Ghanghas



Women's 60kg

When Priya Ghanghas arrived at the Sports Authority of India boxing centre in Bhiwani three years ago, even the coach there wasn't convinced she was special. She had been boxing for several years but had not even won a district title. Her father Mahendra, however, was adamant that the then 16-year-old deserved a chance. He would be proved right. Ghanghas is now a Commonwealth Games champion.

The 20-year-old from Dhanana, a village that has also produced world champions Sakshi Choudhary and Nitu Ghanghas, won gold in Glasgow by beating Scotland's Niamh Mitchell in the quarterfinals, England's Lucy Kings-Wheatley in the semifinals and Canada's Marie-Bathoul Al-Ahmadi by a 4-1 split decision in the 60kg final. The gold is the latest prize in an extraordinary year for Priya. Earlier in 2026, on her senior international debut, Priya won the Asian Championships in Ulaanbaatar.



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Her defining moment there came in the quarterfinals, when she beat former world champion Chengyu Yang 4-1. She then defeated Mongolia's Namuun Monkhon and North Korea's Won Un-gyong for gold.

Priya's wins — especially against Kings-Wheatley in the Commonwealth Games semifinals, where she had to find another gear in the final round — are built on a stubbornness that has been evident

throughout her career. Her father remembers her turning up for 6-am training without ever needing to be woken, while even defeats only convinced her that she needed to work harder. Mahendra himself had plenty of reason to understand that determination. A former kabaddi player who was never allowed to pursue sport, he had decided that his children would get the opportunity he missed. When Vijender Singh won Olympic bronze in 2008, he saw boxing as a route for his children — Priya's brother Neeraj is also a national medallist. Mahendra supported Priya relentlessly, even moving the family to Bhiwani and making her training his priority. At just 20 years old, Priya is now repaying that trust. Her career is only just getting started.



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Arundhati Choudhary



Women's 70kg

Arundhati Choudhary's Commonwealth Games gold is the latest step in a journey that began in perhaps the least likely place for an Indian boxer. While every other Indian to win a boxing gold medal in Glasgow comes from the vicinity of the boxing nursery that is Bhiwani, Arundhati is from Kota in Rajasthan. It's a city far better known for competitive exam preparations than competitive boxing. Choudhary



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was smart enough academically to fit the stereotype. Mathematics came easily to her and her father Suresh, a businessman with little connection to sport, expected her to follow her elder sister into the world of competitive examinations. Instead, at 15, she told him she wanted to win an Olympic gold medal.

There was just one problem. Kota had almost no boxing ecosystem. Choudhary had started out as a

basketball player and there was no established boxing academy or coach to guide her. Her family eventually found a Wushu instructor who had never trained a boxer and learnt techniques from YouTube to teach her.

Somehow, it worked. Choudhary became a junior and youth world champion and eventually established herself as one of India's leading 70kg boxers. But her path was hardly straightforward. In 2018, a bout without headgear left her unconscious and led to a serious head injury that required hospitalisation. Doctors advised her to quit. Her father wanted the same. She refused.

Then came the heartbreak of 2024. During an Olympic qualifier, Choudhary learnt that her mother had been rushed to an ICU. She lost the bout and missed the Paris Olympics. For two months she walked away from boxing. Her return has been nothing short of emphatic. A World Boxing Cup Finals gold and Asian Championships gold preceded Glasgow, where she beat defending Commonwealth champion Rosie Eccles in the semifinal before defeating world bronze medallist Chantelle Reid 5-0 for the 70kg title.